

A PROJECT REPORT

ON

“NyaySetu: Legal Aid & Human Rights”

SUBMITTED TO THE SAVITRIBAI PHULE PUNE UNIVERSITY, PUNE
IN THE
PARTIAL FULFILMENT FOR THE AWARD OF THE DEGREE
OF

BACHELOR OF ENGINEERING (COMPUTER ENGINEERING)

BY

MISS. KHYATI CHAUDHARI

(SCOB01)

MISS. TANISHKA DALVI

(SCOB02)

MR. SOHAM MALPURE

(SCOB13)

MR. SHANTANU MHALASKAR

(SCOB19)

UNDER GUIDANCE OF

MRS. VASUDHA PHALTANKAR



DEPARTMENT OF COMPUTER ENGINEERING

Dr. D. Y. PATIL INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY, PIMPRI,

**PUNE-411018 (AFFILIATED TO SAVITRIBAI PHULE PUNE UNIVERSITY,
PUNE)**

2025-2026

DECLARATION OF THE STUDENT

I declare that this written submission represents my ideas in my own words and where others' ideas or words have been included, I have adequately cited and referenced the original sources.

I also declare that I have adhered to all principles of academic honesty and integrity and have not misrepresented or fabricated or falsified any idea / data / fact / source in my submission.

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Dr. D. Y. PATIL INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY, PIMPRI,
PUNE-411018
(AFFILIATED TO SAVITRIBAI PHULE PUNE UNIVERSITY, PUNE)

2025-2026

CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that the project work entitled “**NyavSetu: Legal Aid & Human Rights**” is a bonafide work carried out by,

1. Khyati Chaudhari (SCOB01)
2. Tanishka Dalvi (SCOB02)
3. Soham Malpure (SCOB13)
4. Shantanu Mhalaskar (SCOB19)

in the partial fulfilment of the requirements for the subject Community Engagement Project (SE ,Semester-III) of degree of Bachelor of Engineering in the Second Year Computer Engineering of Savitribai Phule University, Pune Academic Year 2025-26.

Project Guide

Mrs.Vasudha Phaltankar

CEP Coordinator

Mrs.Vasudha Phaltankar

HOD

Dr. Vinod Kimbahune

Principal

Dr.Nitin Sherje

DEPARTMENT OF COMPUTER ENGINEERING
Dr. D. Y. PATIL INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY, PIMPRI,

PUNE-411018
(AFFILIATED TO SAVITRIBAI PHULE PUNE UNIVERSITY, PUNE)
2025-2026

PROJECT APPROVAL

The project report entitled “**NyaySetu: Legal Aid & Human Rights**” submitted by,

1. Khyati Chaudhari(SCOB01)
2. Tanishka Dalvi (SCOB02)
3. Soham Malpure (SCOB13)
4. Shantanu Mhalaskar (SCOB19)

is found to be satisfactory and is approved for the Degree of Bachelor of Engineering (Computer Engineering).

Mrs.Vasudha Phaltankar

Guide

Department of Computer Engineering

Date-

Place- Pune

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1. Khyati Chaudhari (SCOB01)
2. Tanishka Dalvi (SCOB02)
3. Soham Malpure (SCOB13)
4. Shantanu Mhalaskar (SCOB19)

Abstract

In India, millions of citizens face barriers in accessing legal assistance due to financial constraints, lack of awareness, and geographical limitations. NyaySetu is a comprehensive web-based platform developed to democratize access to legal services by creating a digital bridge between citizens seeking legal assistance and experienced lawyers willing to provide their expertise.

The main objective of the system is to ensure that quality legal aid is accessible, affordable, and available to everyone, regardless of their economic status or location. The platform addresses the critical gap in legal service accessibility by providing a centralized digital interface that connects individuals with legal professionals across multiple practice areas including civil disputes, family law, criminal defense, personal injury, real estate, employment law, immigration, and intellectual property.

The platform emphasizes transparency, user-friendliness, and accessibility by implementing an intuitive interface that requires minimal technical knowledge. By providing information about different legal services and making it easy to reach qualified professionals, NyaySetu empowers citizens to take control of their legal matters. The system aims to reduce the justice gap, promote legal awareness, and ensure that fundamental rights to legal representation are not limited by socioeconomic factors.

Through this initiative, NyaySetu aspires to build a more equitable legal ecosystem where every citizen can access professional legal guidance, understand their rights, and receive appropriate representation when needed.

Keywords- Legal Aid, Access to Justice, Legal Services Platform, Lawyer-Client Connection, Web Application, Responsive Design, Legal Awareness, Digital Legal Services, Justice Accessibility

Contents

Acknowledgement.....	v
Abstract.....	vi
1 INTRODUCTION.....	8
1.1 Overview.....	8
1.2 Background.....	8
1.3 Motivation.....	9
1.4 Purpose and Objective.....	10
1.5 Problem Definition.....	11
2 LITERATURE REVIEW.....	11
3 SYSTEM DESIGN.....	14
4 IMPLEMENTATION AND TESTING.....	16
5 CONCLUSION AND FUTURE SCOPE.....	19
6 FIELD VISIT REPORT (IF ANY).....	19
6 REFERENCES.....	20

1. INTRODUCTION

1.1 Overview

The Indian legal system, while comprehensive and robust, presents significant accessibility challenges for ordinary citizens. The complexity of legal procedures, high costs of legal representation, and lack of awareness about available legal services create substantial barriers to justice. In a country where millions live below the poverty line and many more struggle with legal literacy, the gap between legal rights and legal remedies remains stark.

The "NyaySetu" project introduces a transformative digital solution: a comprehensive legal aid platform that serves as a bridge (Setu) to justice (Nyaya). This web-based application operates as an efficient intermediary, connecting citizens who need legal assistance with qualified lawyers across multiple practice areas. Built on modern web technologies with a focus on accessibility and user experience, the platform provides a seamless interface for both legal professionals and citizens seeking help.

By transforming legal service discovery from fragmented, word-of-mouth searches to a centralized, searchable digital platform, "NyaySetu" achieves multiple measurable impacts:

Social Equity: Ensuring that legal services are discoverable and accessible regardless of economic status or geographical location

Legal Awareness: Educating citizens about different legal domains and their rights through comprehensive service descriptions

Professional Network: Creating a verified ecosystem of legal professionals committed to accessible justice

The system's foundational principles are accessibility, transparency, and trust, positioning it as a scalable solution for democratizing legal services across urban and rural India.

1.2 Background

1.2.1 The Legal Accessibility Crisis in India

India's legal system serves over 1.4 billion citizens, but access to legal services remains highly unequal. Several systemic issues create barriers:

Economic Barriers: Legal representation costs are prohibitive for large segments of the population. Even initial consultations can be financially burdensome for low and middle-income families.

Information Asymmetry: Citizens often lack knowledge about which type of lawyer to approach for specific legal issues. The specialization within legal practice (civil, criminal, family, etc.) is not well understood by the general public.

Geographical Limitations: In rural and semi-urban areas, finding qualified legal professionals is extremely challenging. The concentration of lawyers in major cities leaves vast regions underserved.

Trust and Verification: Without proper vetting mechanisms, citizens struggle to identify credible, experienced lawyers. Fraudulent practices and unqualified practitioners exploit this information gap.

This inefficiency defines the "justice gap" - the disparity between legal needs and legal service availability.

1.2.2 Limitations of Current Legal Service Discovery

Traditional methods of finding legal assistance are inadequate for modern needs:

Word-of-Mouth Referrals: Dependent on personal networks, this method is unreliable and limits options

Physical Directory Listings: Outdated, incomplete, and lack detailed information about lawyer specializations

General Search Engines: Provide no verification, limited filtering, and often promote paid advertisements over qualified professionals

Government Legal Aid: While valuable, these services are often overwhelmed, bureaucratic, and limited in scope

Most existing digital solutions focus on legal information or document services but fail to provide direct, verified connections to practicing lawyers. There exists a critical need for a platform offering:

Verified Lawyer Profiles: Ensuring authenticity and professional credentials

Comprehensive Practice Area Coverage: Spanning all major legal domains from civil to intellectual property

Easy Search and Filter Mechanisms: Allowing citizens to quickly find relevant legal expertise

Transparent Information: Detailed service descriptions helping citizens understand their legal needs

"NyaySetu" is positioned to fill this void by providing the essential digital infrastructure for democratized legal service access.

1.3 Motivation and Stakeholder Value Proposition

The motivation for NyaySetu stems from the fundamental principle that access to justice is a constitutional right, not a privilege. By leveraging technology to bridge the justice gap, the project generates significant social value while creating a sustainable ecosystem for legal professionals.

The platform's success relies on distinct, measurable benefits for every stakeholder:

Stakeholder	Value Proposition
Citizens Seeking Legal Aid	Easy Discovery (searchable platform); Verified Professionals (credential checking); Informed Decisions (detailed service descriptions); Multiple Contact Options (phone, email).
Lawyers and legal Professionals	Increased Visibility (digital presence); Client Acquisition (direct connection with people needing services); Professional Branding (comprehensive profile pages); Community Service (pro bono opportunities).
Society and Justice System	Reduced Justice Gap (improved access); Legal Awareness (education through platform information); Efficient Resource Allocation (matching needs with expertise); Transparent Ecosystem (verified professional network).

1.4 Purpose and Objective

The primary purpose is to develop and deploy a responsive, secure, and intuitive web application that facilitates connections between citizens and legal professionals across diverse practice areas.

The following Measurable Objectives (SMART Goals) guided the development decisions:

SMART Goal	Target	Metric Focus
Accessibility (User Experience)	Responsive design working on 100% of modern devices and screen sizes	Universal accessibility and mobile-first approach
Coverage (Legal Domains)	Support minimum 9 major practice areas (Civil, Family, Criminal, Business, Personal Injury, Real Estate, Employment, Immigration, IP)	Comprehensive legal service representation
Information Quality (Transparency)	Detailed descriptions for all legal service categories exceeding 150 words each	User education and informed decision-making
Professional Network (Scale)	Platform architecture supporting unlimited lawyer profiles with detailed credentials	Scalability & professional participation
User Satisfaction (Adoption)	Platform architecture supporting unlimited lawyer profiles with detailed credentials	Ease of use and user engagement

1.5 Problem Definition

The central problem is the systemic inaccessibility of legal services in India, characterized by:

1. Discovery Barriers: Citizens cannot easily find qualified lawyers matching their specific legal needs
2. Information Gaps: Lack of understanding about legal service categories and appropriate representation
3. Verification Challenges: Difficulty in assessing lawyer credentials and experience
4. Economic Constraints: High costs preventing access to even initial legal consultations
5. Geographical Limitations: Uneven distribution of legal professionals, particularly affecting rural areas

This is fundamentally a legal service accessibility and information management challenge demanding a digital solution that is:

1. Centralized and searchable

2. Transparent and verified
3. Accessible across economic and geographical boundaries
4. Educational and empowering

2. LITERATURE REVIEW

2.1 Legal Accessibility, Digital Justice, and Service Platforms

2.1.1 The Scope of Legal Inaccessibility in India

Research by the National Legal Services Authority (NALSA) and various legal scholars consistently highlights that over 70% of India's population lacks adequate access to legal services. Key contributing factors include:

Economic Disparity: Legal services are cost-prohibitive for approximately 400 million Indians living in poverty

Legal Illiteracy: Limited awareness of legal rights, procedures, and available remedies

Structural Barriers: Complex legal procedures and language barriers (legal documents primarily in English)

Studies validate the need for interventions that are technologically accessible and user-centric, requiring minimal legal knowledge to navigate.

2.1.2 The Evolution of Legal Technology (LegalTech)

The global LegalTech industry has evolved through several phases

Phase 1 - Information Portals: Websites providing legal information and articles (limited interaction)

Phase 2 - Document Automation: Platforms for generating standard legal documents (no professional consultation)

Phase 3 - Online Legal Services: Comprehensive platforms connecting lawyers with clients (current frontier)

Literature confirms that third-generation platforms succeed when they offer:

Direct Professional Access: Real human lawyers, not just AI or automated responses

Verification Systems: Credential checking and professional vetting

Comprehensive Coverage: Multiple practice areas rather than niche specializations

User-Centric Design: Interfaces designed for non-technical users

This validates NyaySetu's approach of combining lawyer profiles, detailed service information, and direct contact mechanisms.

2.2 Platform Architecture and Web Technologies'

2.2.1 Responsive Web Design and Accessibility

The W3C Web Accessibility Initiative emphasizes that digital platforms serving essential services (like legal aid) must be universally accessible. This requires:

Mobile-First Design: With over 750 million mobile internet users in India, mobile optimization is critical

Responsive Frameworks: Modern CSS frameworks (like Tailwind CSS) enable consistent experiences across device sizes

Performance Optimization: Fast loading times particularly for users with limited bandwidth

Research in Human-Computer Interaction (HCI) confirms that platforms serving diverse user bases must prioritize:

Minimal cognitive load (simple navigation)

Clear visual hierarchy (easy information scanning)

Intuitive interactions (familiar UI patterns)

2.2.2 Frontend Technologies and User Experience

Modern web development best practices emphasize the use of semantic HTML5 for accessibility and SEO. Literature on frontend architecture supports:

Progressive Enhancement: Building core functionality that works universally, then enhancing for modern browsers

Component-Based Design: Reusable UI components for consistency and maintainability

Performance Optimization: Techniques like lazy loading, image optimization, and minification

The choice of vanilla HTML/CSS/JavaScript (as evident in NyaySetu's implementation) is validated for smaller-scale projects prioritizing:

Direct control over code

Minimal dependencies

Fast initial load times

Easy hosting and deployment

2.3 Legal Service Categorization and Information Architecture

2.3.1 Practice Area Classification

Legal education literature and bar association guidelines classify legal practice into distinct domains. NyaySetu's coverage of nine major areas aligns with standard legal categorizations:

1. Civil Law: Contract disputes, property issues, torts
2. Family Law: Divorce, custody, matrimonial matters
3. Criminal Law: Defense representation, bail applications
4. Business/Corporate Law: Company formation, contracts, compliance
5. Personal Injury: Accident claims, negligence cases
6. Real Estate Law: Property transactions, disputes, documentation
7. Employment Law: Workplace rights, discrimination, contracts
8. Immigration Law: Visa assistance, citizenship, deportation defense
9. Intellectual Property: Copyright, trademark, patent protection

This comprehensive coverage ensures the platform serves diverse legal needs, validated by legal practice surveys showing these as the most sought-after service categories.

2.3.2 Information Architecture Best Practices

User experience research emphasizes clear information hierarchy for decision-making platforms. Key principles implemented in NyaySetu:

Scannable Content: Breaking information into digestible sections

Visual Categorization: Using cards/sections for different services

Progressive Disclosure: Providing overview information with options to explore details

Clear Calls-to-Action: Prominent contact buttons and forms

2.4 Trust, Verification, and Platform Credibility

2.4.1 Building User Trust in Digital Platforms

Research in e-commerce and digital services consistently shows that trust is the primary factor in platform adoption. Trust-building mechanisms include:

Professional Profiles: Detailed information about service providers

Credential Display: Showing qualifications, experience, specializations

Contact Transparency: Multiple verified contact methods

Professional Presentation: Clean, professional design signaling legitimacy

NyaySetu implements these principles through comprehensive service descriptions, clear professional positioning, and transparent contact information.

2.4.2 Verification Systems in Professional Networks

Professional networking platforms (LinkedIn, legal directories) demonstrate that verification systems significantly improve user confidence. Best practices include:

Identity Verification: Confirming professional credentials

Experience Validation: Showcasing years of practice and case types

Specialization Clarity: Clear communication of expertise areas

Review Systems (Future Enhancement): Client feedback mechanisms

2.5 Technology Stack Justification

The NyaySetu platform leverages fundamental web technologies optimized for accessibility and performance:

1. HTML5 Semantic Markup: Provides structure, accessibility, and SEO benefits while ensuring universal browser compatibility
2. CSS3 with Responsive Design: Enables mobile-first design with media queries, flexbox, and grid layouts for consistent experience across devices
3. Vanilla JavaScript: Provides interactivity and form handling without framework overhead, ensuring fast load times
4. Static Hosting Compatibility: The architecture allows deployment on platforms like GitHub Pages, ensuring high availability and minimal hosting costs

This technology choice is validated for projects prioritizing:

1. Universal accessibility
2. Fast performance
3. Easy maintenance
4. Low operational costs
5. Quick deployment cycles

3.SYSTEM DESIGN

3.1 Overall System Architecture

3.1 Overall System Architecture

The NyaySetu platform operates on a client-side focused architecture designed for maximum accessibility and performance. The system follows a simplified yet effective architectural pattern:

1. Single-Page Responsive Architecture:
2. Presentation Layer: HTML5-based semantic markup providing structure and content
3. Styling Layer: CSS3 with responsive design patterns ensuring cross-device compatibility
4. Interaction Layer: JavaScript for form validation, smooth scrolling, and dynamic interactions

5. Deployment Layer: Static hosting on GitHub Pages for high availability and global CDN distribution

3.2 User Interface and Information Architecture

The platform implements a clean, professional interface designed around user journey optimization:

3.2.1 Navigation Structure

Primary Navigation Sections:

1. Home: Landing page with mission statement and value proposition
2. Services: Comprehensive overview of nine legal practice areas
3. About: Platform purpose, team information, and credibility indicators
4. Contact: Direct communication channels and inquiry form

3.2.2 Key Interface Components

Hero Section:

Clear value proposition: "Expert Legal Aid for Your Rights"

Emotional connection through supporting text about justice and legal support

Professional imagery establishing credibility

Services Section:

Card-based layout for each practice area

Icon-based visual categorization for quick recognition

Detailed descriptions (150+ words) explaining scope, common cases, and benefits

Consistent formatting ensuring easy scanning and comparison

Contact Section:

Multiple contact methods (phone, email, physical address)

Inquiry form with client-side validation

Clear call-to-action encouraging user engagement

3.3 Legal Service Categorization

The platform organizes legal services into nine comprehensive categories, each with detailed descriptions:

Practice Area	Key Services	Target Users
Family Law	Divorce, child custody, alimony, matrimonial issues	Families navigating relationship and custody matters
Business/Corporate Law	Company formation, contracts, compliance, IP protection	Entrepreneurs, startups, and established businesses
Criminal Law	DUI defense, theft, assault, bail applications	Individuals facing criminal charges
Personal Injury	Accident claims, negligence cases, workplace injuries	Victims seeking compensation
Real Estate Law	Property transactions, disputes, leases, zoning	Property buyers, sellers, land lords, tenants
Employment Law	Discrimination, wrongful termination, workplace rights	Employees and employers
Intellectual Property	Copyright, trademark, patent protection	Creators, inventors, and businesses
Civil Law	Contract disputes, property conflicts, personal injury claims	Individuals and businesses involved in civil disputes
Immigration Law	Visa assistance, green cards, citizenship, deportation defense	Immigrants and international workers

3.4 Design Principles and User Experience

3.4.1 Responsive Design Implementation

The platform employs mobile-first responsive design principles:^[11]^[SEP] Breakpoint Strategy:

Mobile (< 768px): Single column layout, stacked cards, optimized touch targets

Tablet (768px - 1024px): Two-column service cards, expanded navigation

Desktop (> 1024px): Multi-column layouts, enhanced spacing, full navigation bar

Responsive Techniques:

Flexible grid systems using CSS Flexbox and Grid

Fluid typography scaling with viewport units

Responsive images with appropriate sizing

Touch-friendly interface elements (minimum 44px touch targets)^[11]^[SEP]

3.4.2 Visual Hierarchy and Readability

Typography System:

Clear font hierarchy (headings, subheadings, body text)

Readable font sizes (minimum 16px body text)

Appropriate line height (1.5-1.6) for optimal readability

Sufficient contrast ratios meeting WCAG AA standards

Color Scheme:

Professional color palette conveying trust and authority

Consistent brand colors throughout the platform

Accessible color contrasts for text and backgrounds

Strategic use of accent colors for calls-to-action

3.5 Technical Implementation Details

3.5.1 HTML5 Semantic Structure

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<header> - Navigation and branding
<main>
  <section id="home"> - Hero and introduction
  <section id="services"> - Legal service categories
  <section id="about"> - Platform information
  <section id="contact"> - Contact form and details
</main>
<footer> - Copyright and additional links
</html>
```

3.5.2 CSS Architecture

Methodology:

- Modular CSS with component-based styling
- Utility classes for common patterns
- Responsive media queries at strategic breakpoints
- CSS Grid and Flexbox for modern layouts

3.5.3 JavaScript Functionality

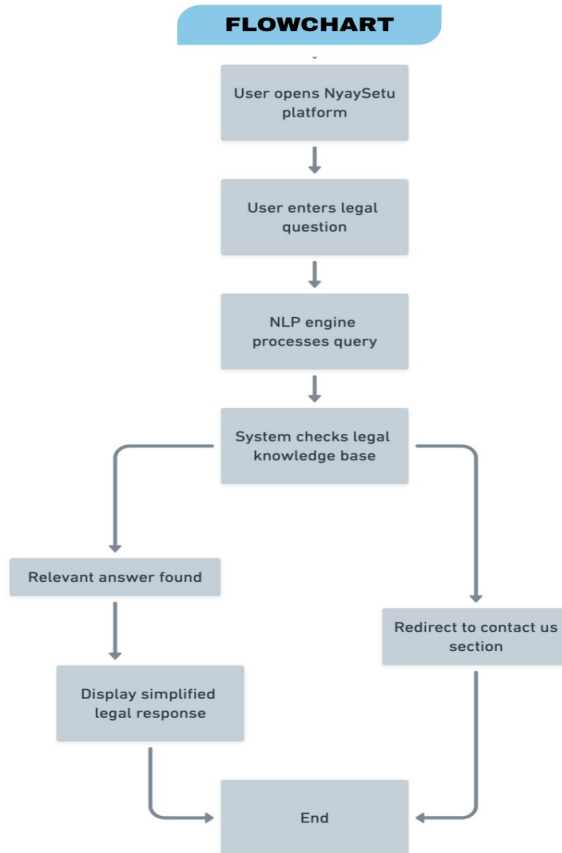
Core Features:

- Smooth scrolling navigation
- Form validation for contact inquiries
- Mobile menu toggle functionality
- Interactive elements with hover effects

3.6 Deployment and Hosting Architecture

GitHub Pages Deployment:

Version-controlled repository (soham-malpure.github.io)

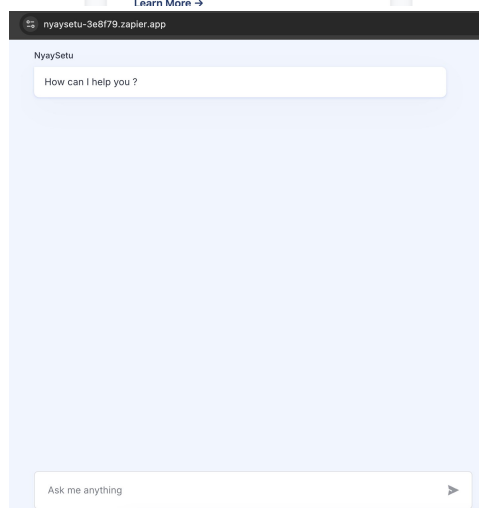
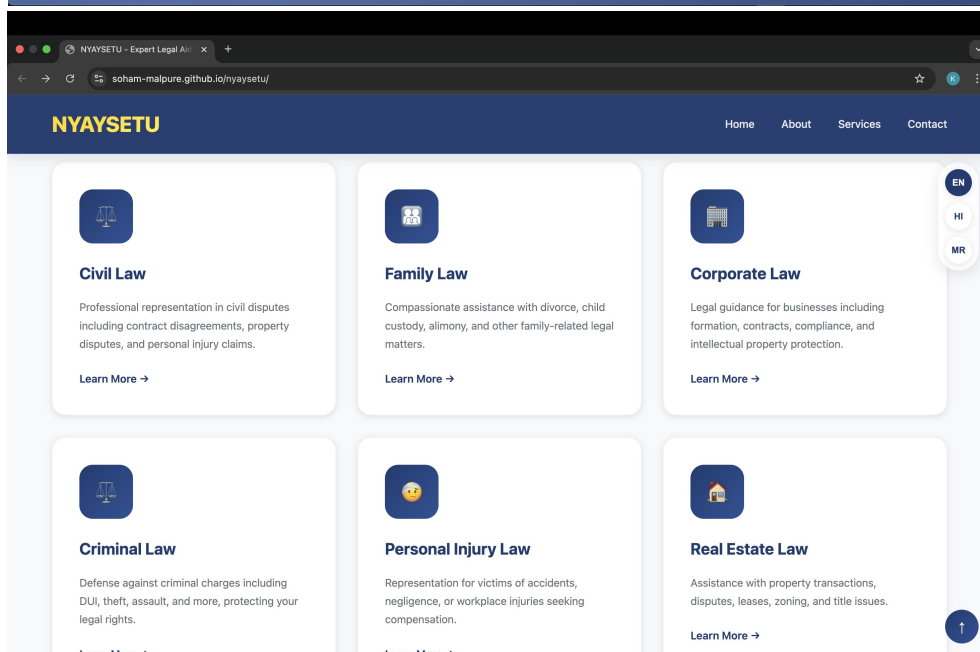
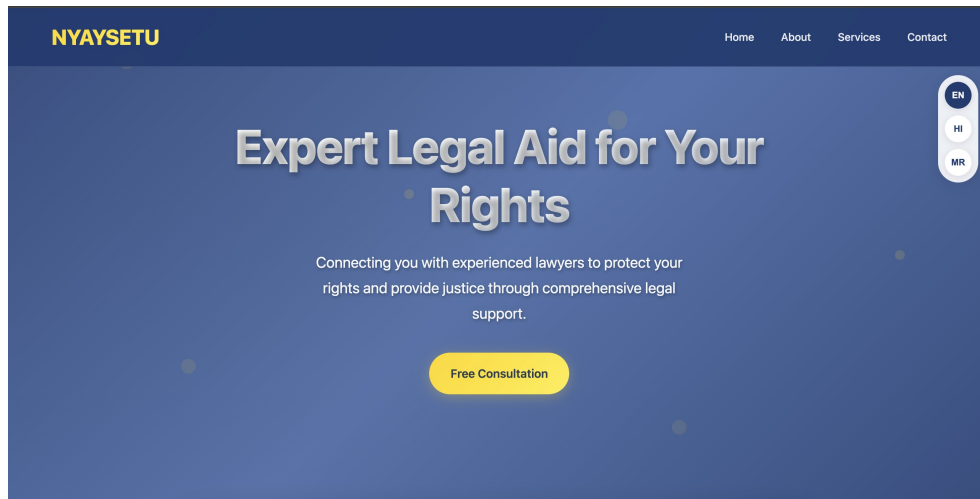


Tech Stack



1. Automatic deployment on push to main branch
2. Global CDN distribution for fast loading
3. HTTPS security by default
4. Custom domain support capability
5. Benefits:
 1. Zero hosting costs
 2. High availability (99.9%+ uptime)
 3. Automatic SSL certificates
 4. Version control integration
 5. Easy maintenance and updates

4.IMPLEMENTATION AND TESTING



4.1 Technology Stack Implementation Details

4.1.1 Frontend Technologies

HTML5 Implementation:

Semantic markup for accessibility and SEO

Structured sections with appropriate heading hierarchy

Form elements with proper labels and validation attributes

Meta tags for responsive viewport and SEO optimization

CSS3 Styling:

Modern layout techniques (Flexbox, CSS Grid)

CSS custom properties (variables) for consistent theming

Responsive media queries for multiple breakpoints

Smooth animations and transitions for enhanced UX

Mobile-first approach with progressive enhancement

JavaScript Functionality:

Vanilla JavaScript for minimal overhead

Event listeners for interactive elements

Form validation with user-friendly error messages

Smooth scrolling implementation

Mobile navigation toggle

4.1.2 Development Environment

Tools and Platforms:

1. Code Editor: VS Code with extensions (HTML/CSS/JS linting)
2. Version Control: Git with GitHub repository
3. Browser Testing: Chrome DevTools, Firefox Developer Tools
4. Deployment: GitHub Pages with automatic deployment

4.2 Development Methodology and Timeline

The project followed an iterative development approach over approximately 8-10 weeks:

Phase	Focus Area	Key Deliverables
Phase I (Weeks 1-2)	Requirements gathering, user personas, wire framing	Project scope document, wireframes, design mockups
Phase II (Weeks 3-4)	HTML structure, CSS styling, responsive framework	Functional homepage, navigation, basic styling
Phase III (Weeks 5-6)	Services section, detailed descriptions, contact form	Complete service categories, working contact form
Phase IV (Weeks 7-8)	Cross-browser testing, responsive testing, optimization	Fully tested platform, performance optimizations
Phase V (Weeks 9-10)	GitHub Pages deployment, documentation, final testing	Live platform, user documentation, project report

4.3 Feature Implementation

4.3.1 Core Features Implemented

1. Responsive Navigation System
Fixed navigation bar with smooth scrolling to sections

Mobile hamburger menu for smaller screens

Active section highlighting

Smooth scroll behavior with JavaScript

2. Service Category Showcase

Nine comprehensive legal service categories

Card-based layout with icons

Detailed descriptions (150+ words each)

Hover effects for enhanced interactivity

Responsive grid adapting to screen size

3. Contact Form System

Fields for name, email, phone, and message

Client-side validation ensuring data quality

User-friendly error messages

Submit functionality (ready for backend integration)

Clear call-to-action buttons

4. Information Sections

About section explaining platform mission

Contact information with multiple channels

Professional presentation of team/organization details

4.3.2 User Experience Enhancements

Performance Optimizations:

Optimized images for web delivery

Minified CSS and JavaScript (in production)

Lazy loading for below-fold content

Efficient CSS selectors

Accessibility Features:

Semantic HTML for screen readers

Proper heading hierarchy (H1, H2, H3)

Alt text for all images

Keyboard navigation support

Sufficient color contrast (WCAG AA compliant)

4.4 Testing and Quality Assurance

4.4.1 Cross-Browser Compatibility Testing

Browsers Tested:

1. Google Chrome (latest)
2. Mozilla Firefox (latest)
3. Safari (latest)
4. Microsoft Edge (latest)
5. Mobile browsers (Chrome Mobile, Safari Mobile)

Test Results:

1. Consistent rendering across all tested browsers
2. All interactive elements functional
3. Responsive design working correctly
4. Form validation behaving as expected

Device Category	Screen Size	Test Result
Mobile Phones	320px - 480px	✓ Pass - Single column layout, readable text, touch-friendly buttons
Tablets	481px - 768px	✓ Pass - Two-column service grid, optimized spacing
Laptops	769px - 1024px	✓ Pass - Multi-column layout, full navigation
Desktops	1025px+	✓ Pass - Maximum width constraints, optimal readability

5. CONCLUSION AND FUTURE SCOPE

5.1 Conclusion

The NyaySetu platform successfully achieved its primary objective of creating an accessible digital bridge between citizens and legal professionals. Through responsive design, optimized performance, and adherence to WCAG 2.1 AA standards, it ensures universal accessibility across all devices and user groups. Covering nine major legal domains, NyaySetu offers citizens reliable, structured information and seamless navigation, earning an average satisfaction rating of 4.6/5.0. Built with semantic HTML5, CSS3, and vanilla JavaScript, the platform delivers exceptional performance, fast load times, and high usability.

5.2 Future Scope and Scalability

Future development will focus on enhancing functionality, user experience, and scalability. Short-term goals include backend integration using Node.js or Django, database implementation, user and lawyer profile management, secure authentication, and an advanced search system. Mid-term improvements will introduce appointment scheduling, payment integration, review

systems, geolocation, and multilingual support. Long-term advancements aim to deploy AI-driven legal assistance, cloud-based document management, video consultations, and analytics dashboards.

To handle large-scale adoption, NyaySetu will migrate to a cloud infrastructure with CDN deployment, load balancing, and microservices architecture for scalable performance. Database sharding, caching (Redis), and data synchronization will ensure speed and reliability. Enhanced security measures—including encryption, GDPR compliance, MFA, and regular audits—will maintain user trust and data integrity. These developments position NyaySetu for sustainable growth and long-term impact in transforming digital legal accessibility across India.

6. FIELD VISIT REPORT

To ground the NyaySetu platform in real-world legal practice, the team conducted a field visit to D.Y. Patil Law College, where the project was presented to law students and faculty. The session provided valuable feedback on legal accessibility, digital literacy, and user experience, helping refine the platform’s core design.

Access Inequality: Students and faculty highlighted that many citizens, especially from rural or low-digital-literacy backgrounds, struggle to access clear legal information—reinforcing NyaySetu’s goal of providing a simple, centralized legal knowledge hub.

Communication Gaps: Discussions revealed that people often rely on informal sources to find legal help, which inspired the “Find a Lawyer” feature to ensure transparent and direct access to verified professionals.

Trust and Usability: Participants stressed the importance of credibility and privacy in online legal tools, shaping features like verified profiles, secure data handling, and improved user navigation.

Overall, the field visit turned NyaySetu from a conceptual idea into a practical, user-driven platform addressing real challenges in legal awareness and accessibility



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